HD-005

Critical

Affected User	Domain
Many	**aklab.local**

Issue:
Unable to Access the CompanyShare Network.
After the company policy was updated recently, all the users are unable to access the CompanyShare Network.

Environment: DC01 (domain controller) and CLIENT01 (Windows client)

1. Issue Description

After the company policy was updated recently, all users are unable to access the CompanyShare Network. No folder or file can be accessed, which is affecting work critically and needs a quick fix. It is costing a lot of money for the company.

2. Environment

- User account: Many accounts
- Shared resource: \\DC01\CompanyShare

3. Investigation

- Verifying the query by remotely connecting to a user desktop:

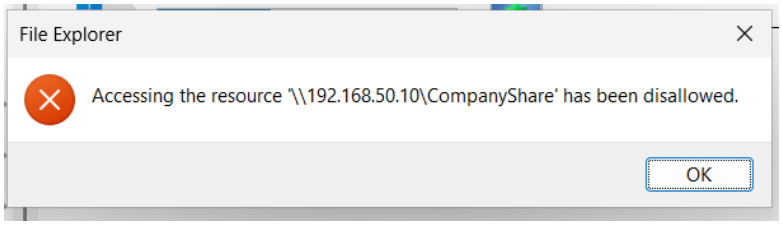


Figure 1: The message read that accessing the resource is disallowed.

- Trying to reach the folder through cmd:

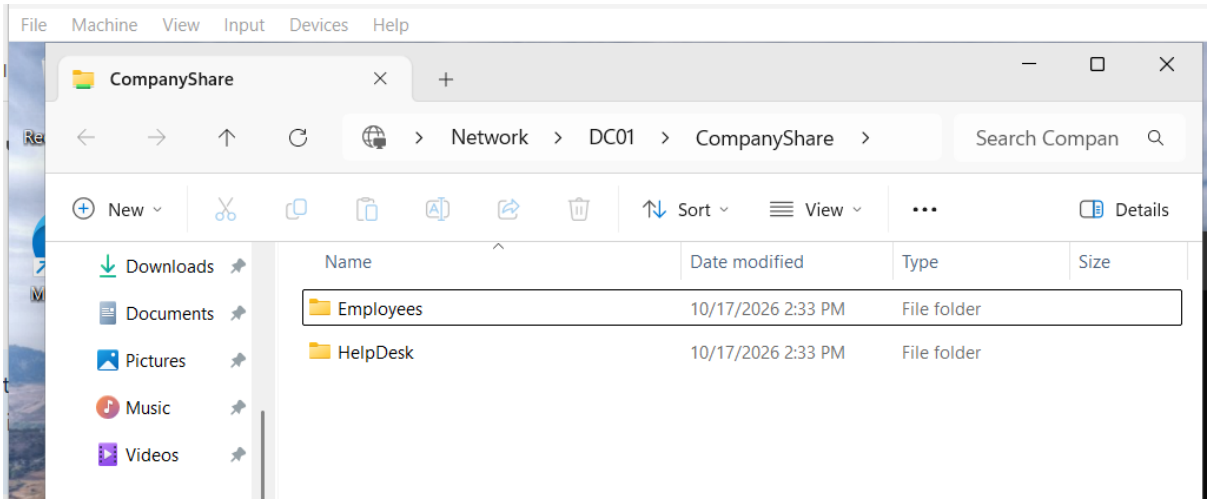


Figure 2: The company folders successfully opened through cmd

- This means that the folders are accessible by the accounts, so the issue is not the permissions, let's try copying the path from the current window which is <\\DC01\CompanyShare> and then searching again.

  The message pop ups again that the Access is disallowed.

Let's try to open anything else through the address bar:

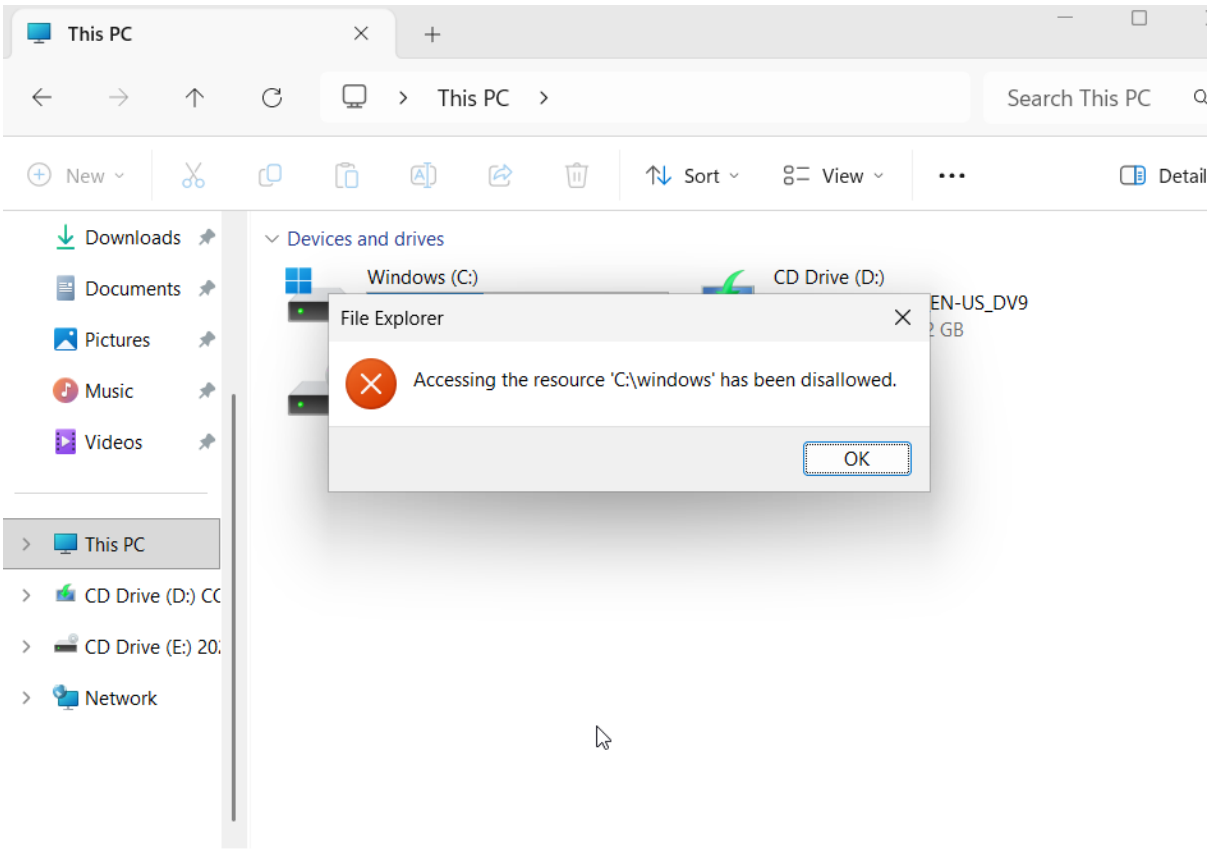


Figure 3: Failed to open C: drive

This shows that the issue is with the address bar and not the permissions.

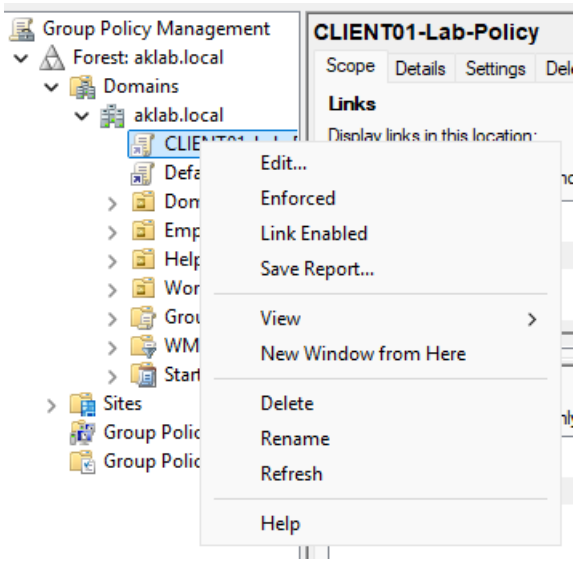


Figure 4: Verifying which policy is causing the issue

Checking under CLIENT01-Lab-Policy> User Configuration > Policies > Administrative Templates > Start Menu and Taskbar

Found out that the policy named <Remove Run Menu from Start Menu> might be causing issue as it is set to Not Configured.

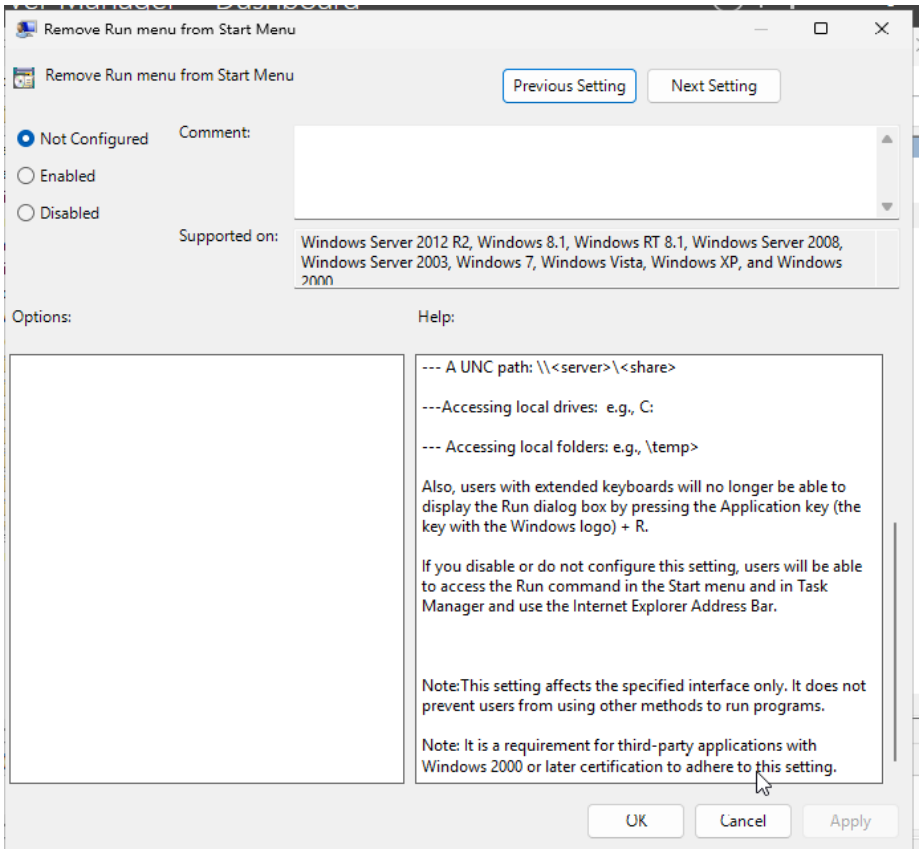


Figure 5: Remove Run from Start Menu is set to Not Configured

Changing the setting to Disabled:

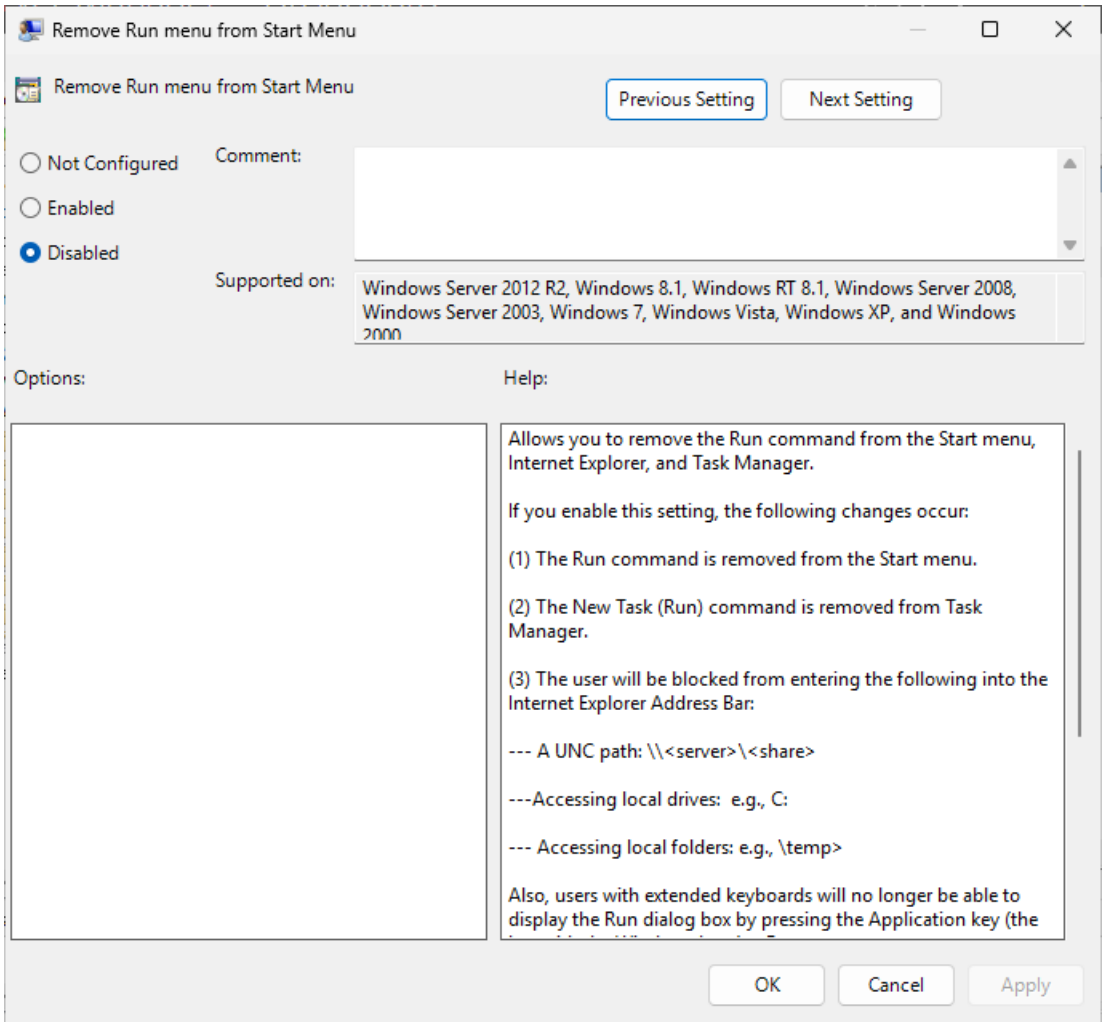


Figure 6: Remove Run menu from Start Menu is set to Disabled

4. Root Cause

The policy was creating issues in the working of the address bar search.

5. Resolution

Change the <Remove Run from Start Menu> from Not Configured to Disabled.

6. Validation

Verifying if the address bar started working now:

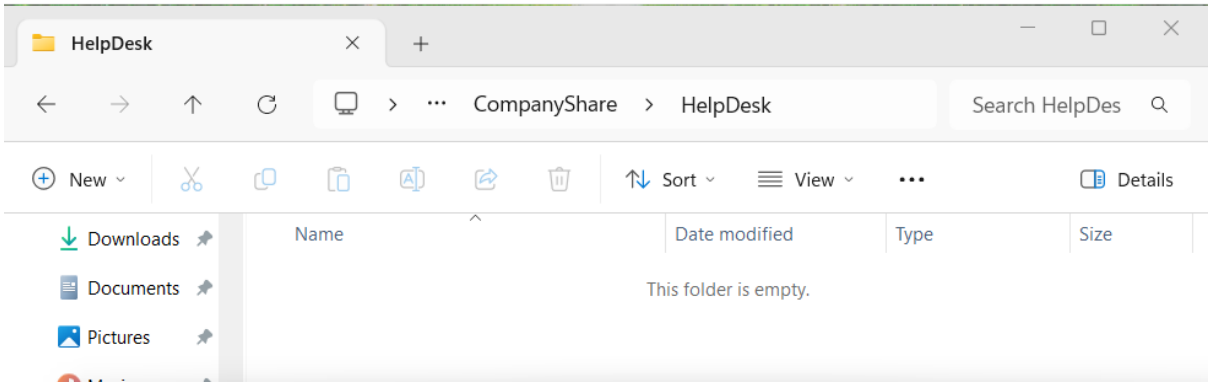


Figure 7: The resources can successfully accessed now.

7. Lessons Learned:

1. Why it failed when "Enabled"

When you Enable a restriction policy (like *"Remove Run menu from Start Menu"*), you are explicitly telling Windows: *"Activate this restriction."*

- The Connection: Under the hood, Windows treats the File Explorer address bar and the Win + R Run dialog box as the exact same core feature.
- The Result: By enabling the policy to block the Run menu, Windows automatically locked down the address bar as well, throwing the "Disallowed" error to prevent unauthorized commands or file paths from being executed.

2. Why it still failed when "Not Configured"

"Not Configured" simply means *"this specific GPO will not enforce any opinion on this setting."* It does not mean the feature turns back on automatically. It failed for two common Group Policy reasons:

- Tattooing (Registry Persistence): When you change a GPO from *Enabled* to *Not Configured*, Windows often retains the previous restricted registry keys (a behavior known as "tattooing"). The operating system won't change its state until a policy explicitly tells it to do so.
- GPO Inheritance / Conflicts: In a Windows Server Active Directory environment, multiple GPOs apply at once. If another policy (like the *Default Domain Policy* or a local server policy) had this restriction turned on, setting your new GPO to *Not Configured*

allowed that other restrictive policy to take control and keep it blocked.

Ticket Resolved!